

Peak Quarter

804K

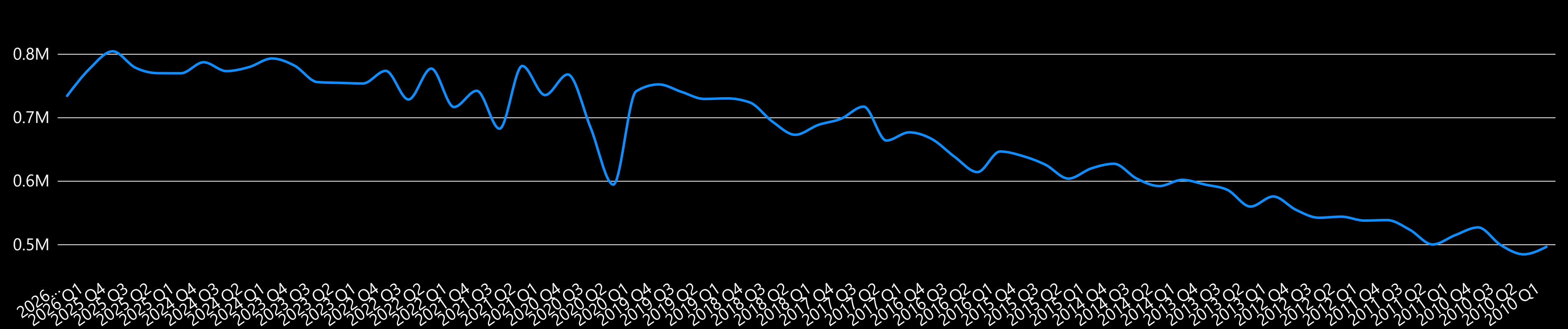
Average Quarterly
Presentations

668K

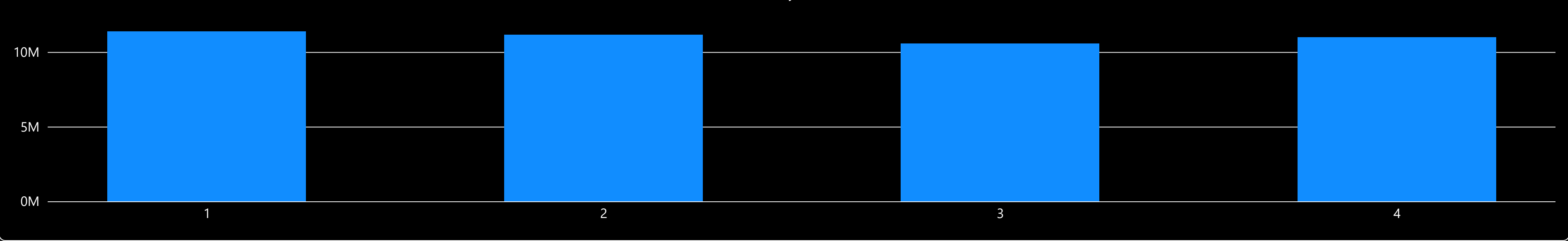
Latest Quarter Presentations

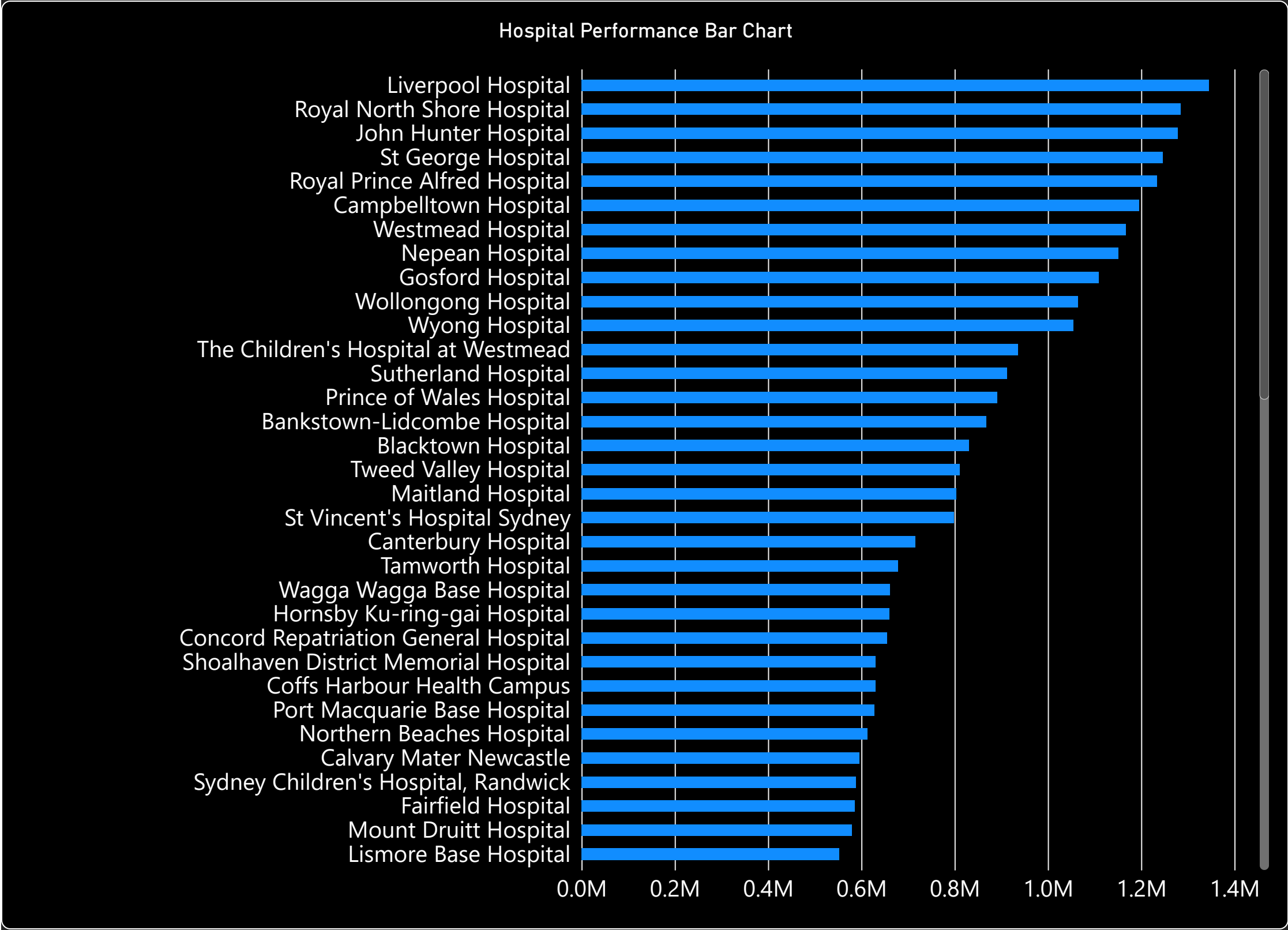
804K

Overral Demand Trend



Demand By Quarter





Hospital Names

Names

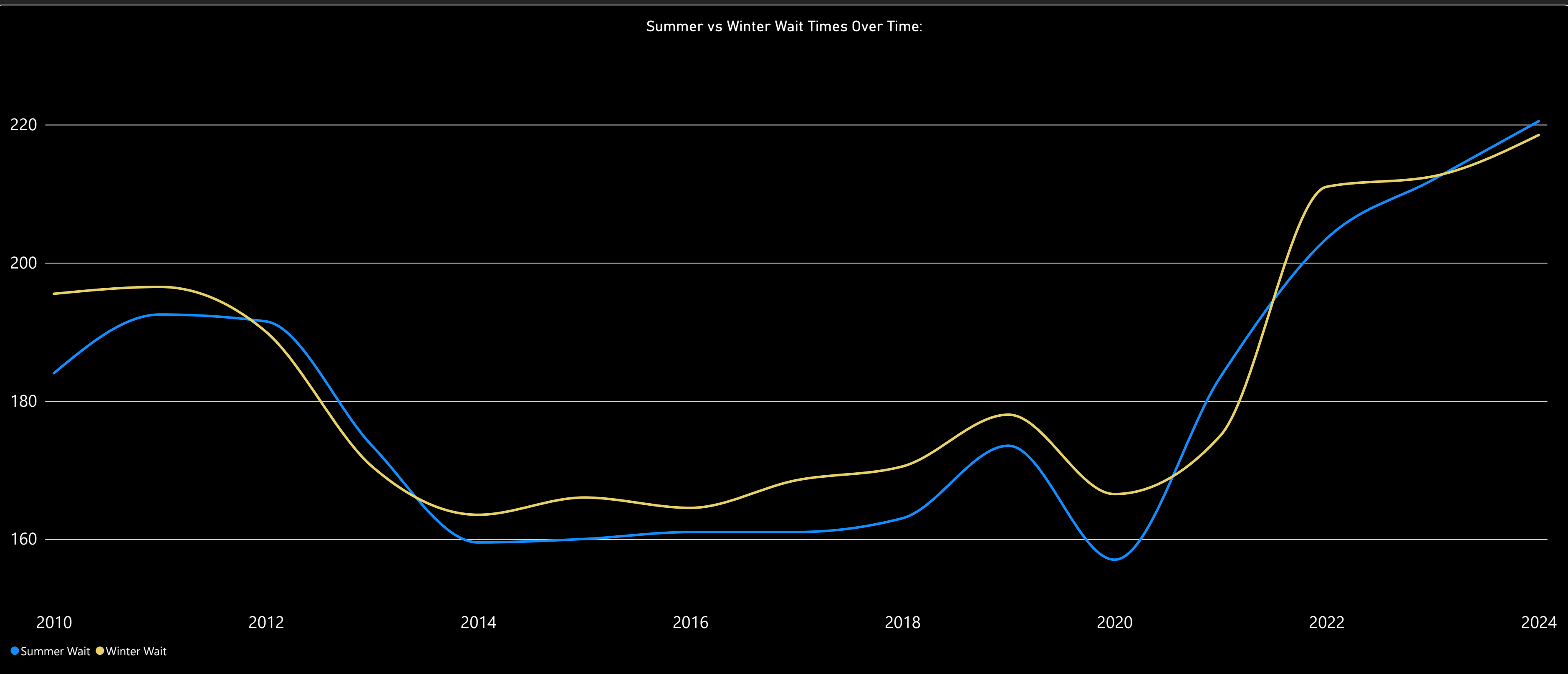
All

Hospital Name	Summer Performance	Winter Performance	Winter Drop
Young Health Service	93.02	92.83	0.19
Wyong Hospital	62.19	61.23	0.96
Wollongong Hospital	53.64	52.51	1.13
Westmead Hospital	48.39	45.30	3.10
Wagga Wagga Base Hospital	61.95	61.47	0.48
Tweed Valley Hospital	73.48	73.22	0.27
The Children's Hospital at Westmead	62.84	63.37	-0.53
Tamworth Hospital	64.67	63.20	1.47
Sydney Hospital and Sydney Eye Hospital	85.94	86.68	-0.74
Sydney Children's Hospital, Randwick	72.67	73.05	-0.38
Sutherland Hospital	61.52	58.90	2.62
St Vincent's Hospital Sydney	59.72	58.93	0.80
St George Hospital	59.63	57.47	2.16
South East Regional Hospital	75.53	74.55	0.98
Singleton Hospital	91.68	91.07	0.61
Shoalhaven District Memorial Hospital	59.87	59.82	0.05
Shellharbour Hospital	61.83	60.45	1.38
Ryde Hospital	75.50	74.22	1.28
Royal Prince Alfred Hospital	57.71	57.53	0.19
Royal North Shore Hospital	57.88	56.88	1.00
Queanbeyan Hospital and Health Service	84.41	83.88	0.53
Prince of Wales Hospital	61.93	59.03	2.90
Port Macquarie Base Hospital	69.58	68.68	0.90
Orange Health Service	68.60	67.55	1.05
Northern Beaches Hospital	66.83	66.80	0.03
Total	71.75	70.86	0.89

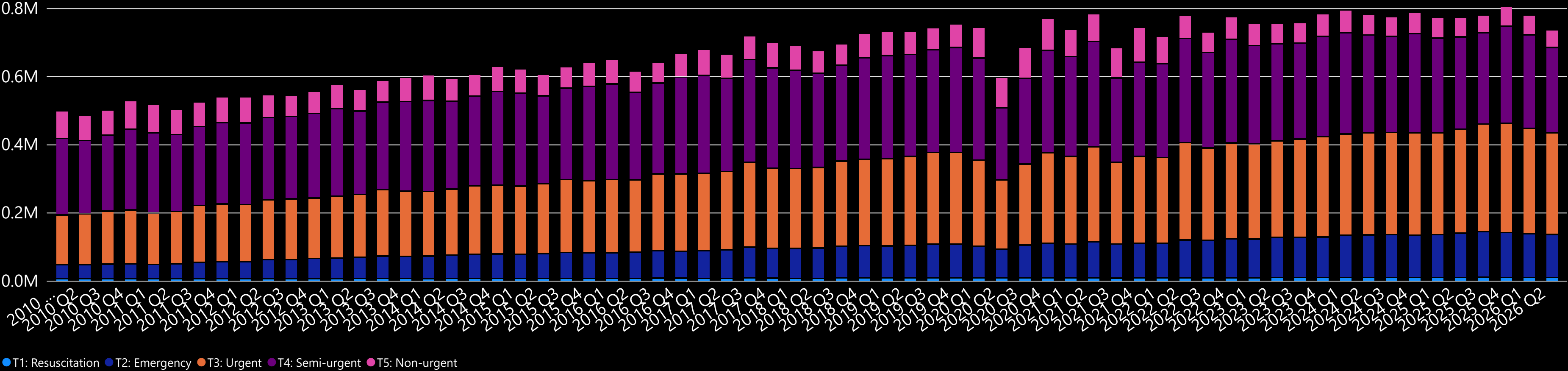
Wait Time Premium Card

3.40

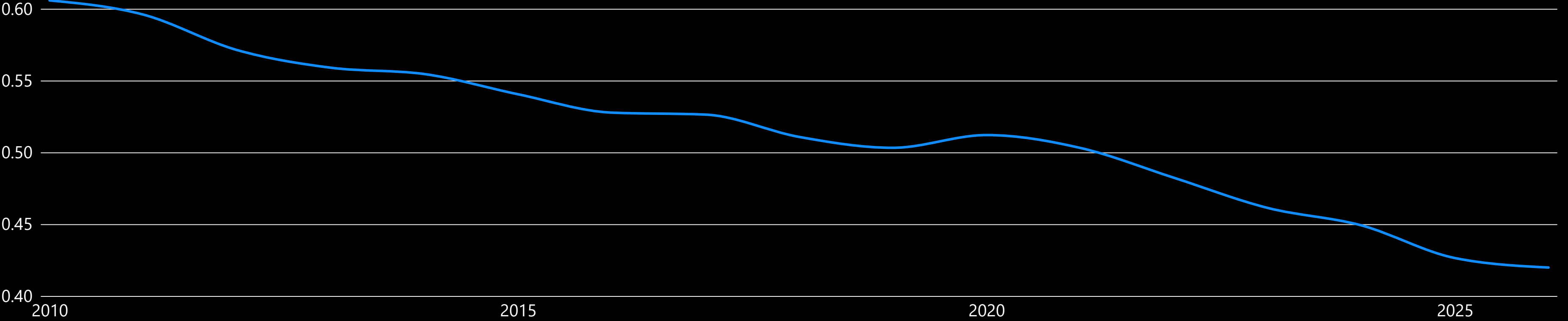
Summer vs Winter Wait Times Over Time:



Presentations by Triage



Low Acuity % by Year



FINDING 1: ED demand has grown 60% in 16 years
NSW emergency presentations grew from ~500,000 to 804,000 per quarter. The most recent quarter matches the all-time peak. This growth shows no signs of slowing.

FINDING 2: Wait times have reached critical levels
Median time in ED has risen from 160 minutes in 2014 to over 220 minutes in 2024, a 37% increase. This deterioration is happening in both summer and winter, indicating a systemic capacity issue rather than a purely seasonal one.

FINDING 3: The growth is driven by genuinely sick patients
Low-acuity presentations (T4-T5) have dropped from 60% to 42% of total demand since 2010, suggesting GP diversion efforts are working. However, high-acuity presentations (T1-T3) are increasing, these patients cannot be redirected and require full emergency resources.

FINDING 4: Specific hospitals are under severe pressure
Fairfield Hospital (3.03% winter drop), Blacktown Hospital (2.13%), Westmead Hospital, Sutherland Hospital, and Bowral Hospital show the largest performance declines during winter. Some of these still report above-benchmark numbers overall but are deteriorating fastest, making them at risk of failure in the near term.

FINDING 5: Post-COVID demand exceeds pre-COVID peaks
Despite a sharp drop during 2020-2021, demand has not only recovered but surpassed 2018 peak levels, while staffing and capacity have not scaled proportionally, as evidenced by the steep rise in wait times.

RECOMMENDATIONS

1. Targeted winter staffing for at-risk hospitals
Hospitals with the highest winter performance drops — particularly Fairfield, Blacktown, and Westmead — should receive temporary staffing increases during July-September each year.
2. Capacity investment, not just GP diversion
GP diversion is already working (low-acuity share down 18 percentage points). The remaining demand growth is high-acuity patients who genuinely need emergency care. Investment in ED capacity, beds, and permanent staffing is required.
3. Early warning monitoring system
Hospitals that currently pass benchmarks but show large seasonal declines (e.g. Fairfield, Sutherland) should be flagged for proactive intervention before they breach performance thresholds.
4. Post-COVID wait time investigation
The sharp rise in wait times from 2021 onwards warrants further investigation — whether driven by workforce shortages, increased complexity of presentations, or infrastructure constraints.

NSW Emergency Department Analysis: Key Findings & Recommendations
Data Source: Bureau of Health Information (Jan 2010 – Jun 2026)